AMAZON

Rules & Company Policies

Public-source research guide | Amazon

A structured overview of Amazon's published Code of Business Conduct and Ethics, Leadership Principles, and public workplace information. This is a research guide, not a reproduction of Amazon's internal employee handbook.

Document type: Public-source research guide
Prepared: 23 October 2026
Coverage: Public information and general employee guidance

Important: This is not an official Amazon-issued document, not legal advice, and not a substitute for internal policies or local employment terms.

01 | How to use this guide

A structured overview of Amazon's published Code of Business Conduct and Ethics, Leadership Principles, and public workplace information. This is a research guide, not a reproduction of Amazon's internal employee handbook.

Purpose and scope

This document organizes publicly available Amazon materials into a practical employee-policy reference. It focuses on conduct, compliance, conflicts of interest, respectful workplace expectations, safety, reporting, and leadership behaviours.

Evidence standard

Company-specific statements below are based on Amazon's public Code of Business Conduct and Ethics, Leadership Principles, and workplace pages. Where a detailed local procedure is not public, this guide says so rather than inventing a rule.

Important boundary

Amazon operates across countries, business units, sites, and job types. Local employment terms and operational procedures may differ. This guide should not be treated as a substitute for current internal policy, manager guidance, HR, Legal, or local law.

02 | Code of conduct: the foundation

Core expectation

Amazon's public Code says employees should act lawfully, ethically, and in the best interests of Amazon.com while performing their duties. It provides guiding principles and directs employees with questions to management or Legal.

Compliance with laws

Employees are expected to follow applicable laws, rules, and regulations. In practice, this means pausing and asking for guidance when a business request appears to conflict with law or company requirements.

Practical scenario

If a colleague asks you to bypass a required approval, alter a record, or conceal an error, do not assume the request is acceptable because it comes from a senior person. Preserve accurate records and seek the appropriate channel.

Employee takeaway: Verify the current local policy before taking action; ask the authorised internal team when a rule, eligibility condition, or approval path is unclear.

03 | Conflicts of interest

What a conflict means

A conflict may arise when a personal interest, outside activity, relationship, or financial interest interferes—or appears to interfere—with objective work decisions. Amazon's Code includes conflicts of interest as a named section.

Common risk patterns

Examples to assess include hiring or supervising a close relative without disclosure, using company information for personal benefit, accepting an inappropriate gift, or making a supplier decision where you have a personal stake.

Good practice

Disclose potential conflicts early and follow the guidance from the appropriate manager or Legal contact. This guide does not invent monetary gift limits or approval thresholds because those details must come from the applicable current policy.

Employee takeaway: Verify the current local policy before taking action; ask the authorised internal team when a rule, eligibility condition, or approval path is unclear.

04 | Insider trading and confidential information

Why it matters

Amazon's Code includes an Insider Trading Policy. Employees who may have material non-public information about a company must be careful not to trade securities or share such information improperly.

Examples of sensitive information

Unreleased financial results, acquisitions, major business changes, or other non-public information may be sensitive. Whether information is material and non-public is a legal question; do not make assumptions based on rumours.

Safe response

Do not trade or tip others based on non-public information. Follow applicable trading windows and pre-clearance requirements if they apply to your role, and contact Legal or the designated compliance resource when uncertain.

Employee takeaway: Verify the current local policy before taking action; ask the authorised internal team when a rule, eligibility condition, or approval path is unclear.

05 | Respectful workplace and non-discrimination

Published position

Amazon's Code states that the company provides equal opportunity in employment and will not tolerate illegal discrimination or harassment.

Everyday behaviours

Use respectful language, focus feedback on work, avoid degrading jokes or unwanted conduct, and do not make employment decisions based on protected characteristics or stereotypes.

Escalation

If you experience or observe harassment or discrimination, use the reporting channels identified by the applicable local policy. The public Code points to additional workplace harassment and equal-employment policies, but not every internal process is publicly reproduced here.

Employee takeaway: Verify the current local policy before taking action; ask the authorised internal team when a rule, eligibility condition, or approval path is unclear.

06 | Health, safety, and security

Published responsibility

Amazon's Code describes a clean, safe, and healthy work environment as a company priority and states employees share responsibility for following safety practices and reporting accidents, injuries, unsafe conditions, procedures, or behaviours.

Immediate hazards

Do not ignore a hazard because production or a deadline is urgent. Where safe, stop the risky activity, warn affected people, and report through the site's designated safety process.

Threats and impairment

The public Code says violence and threatening behaviour are not permitted and employees must be able to perform their duties without the influence of illegal drugs or alcohol.

Employee takeaway: Verify the current local policy before taking action; ask the authorised internal team when a rule, eligibility condition, or approval path is unclear.

07 | Anti-bribery and fair competition

Bribery

Amazon's Code says employees may not bribe anyone for any reason, including through third parties. It specifically discusses restrictions involving government officials and directs employees to Legal for guidance.

Competition

The Code includes price fixing and antitrust topics. Employees should not coordinate prices, discounts, business terms, or market allocation with competitors in ways that violate applicable law.

Scenario

If a competitor suggests agreeing on future prices or dividing customers, do not participate. End the conversation appropriately and report it through the approved channel.

Employee takeaway: Verify the current local policy before taking action; ask the authorised internal team when a rule, eligibility condition, or approval path is unclear.

08 | Records, reporting, and investigations

Accurate records

Amazon's Code says company books, records, accounts, and financial statements must be maintained with appropriate detail and reflect transactions properly and in accordance with law and internal controls.

Speak up

The Code describes reporting guidelines and states Amazon does not allow retaliation against an employee who reports misconduct in good faith.

Cooperation

The Code says employees must cooperate with internal investigations into potential or alleged misconduct. Preserve relevant records and avoid speculation, retaliation, or attempts to influence witnesses.

Employee takeaway: Verify the current local policy before taking action; ask the authorised internal team when a rule, eligibility condition, or approval path is unclear.

09 | Leadership Principles in daily work

Culture framework

Amazon publicly describes Leadership Principles as a guide to how it does business, how leaders lead, and how it keeps customers central to decisions.

Examples

Customer Obsession means working backward from customer needs; Ownership means considering long-term and cross-team impact; Learn and Be Curious means continuing to improve; Earn Trust emphasizes listening, candour, and respect.

Accountability

The published set also includes high standards, Dive Deep, Bias for Action, Deliver Results, and Strive to Be Earth's Best Employer. These are cultural principles, not a complete list of detailed HR procedures.

Employee takeaway: Verify the current local policy before taking action; ask the authorised internal team when a rule, eligibility condition, or approval path is unclear.

10 | Quick-reference checklist and source notes

Before acting

Ask: Is it lawful? Is the record accurate? Is there a conflict? Is customer or employee information protected? Is anyone at risk? Do I need manager, HR, Legal, or Safety guidance?

If unsure

Use the official policy available for your country, job family, and site. Do not rely on an unofficial summary for disciplinary, employment, legal, or trading decisions.

Sources

Amazon Code of Business Conduct and Ethics; Amazon Leadership Principles; Amazon Our Workplace. URLs are listed in the final Sources section.

Sources & verification notes

The following public sources informed this guide. Accessed/checked for this preparation date; web content can change. Use the live source for the latest wording.

- **Amazon Code of Business Conduct and Ethics**
https://ir.aboutamazon.com/corporate-governance/documents-and-charters/code-of-business-conduct-and-ethics/default.aspx

- **Amazon Leadership Principles**
https://www.aboutamazon.com/about-us/leadership-principles

- **Amazon Our Workplace**
https://www.amazon.jobs/content/en/our-workplace

- **Amazon workplace safety overview**
https://www.aboutamazon.com/news/operations/safety

- **Amazon corporate governance documents**
https://ir.aboutamazon.com/corporate-governance/documents-and-charters/

Research integrity note: Where Amazon's public sources did not specify an internal rule, exact entitlement, limit, or process, this guide does not invent one. Public U.S. benefits are labelled as U.S.-specific and must not be assumed to apply to Amazon India.